Deep-Clean vs. Daily-Done

Coral = once-a-season deep cleans. Teal = the small dailies that protect them.

Season deep cleans — mark when done

- [ ] Wash curtains
- [ ] Clean behind fridge coils
- [ ] Wipe tops of cabinets
- [ ] Dust ceiling fans & light fixtures
- [ ] Mattress flip/rotate + vacuum
- [ ] Wash baseboards
- [ ] Grout & tile deep scrub
- [ ] Oven interior
- [ ] Fridge interior emptied & washed
- [ ] Junk drawer emptied entirely
- [ ] Washing machine hoses checked
- [ ] Smoke alarm battery test
- [ ] Vacuum mattress sides & sofa cracks
- [ ] Winter bedding swapped in/out
- [ ] Garage sweep
- [ ] Patio furniture hose-down
- [ ] Cushions out, sofa crevices cleaned
- [ ] Dryer lint deep-vent clean
- [ ] Wipe out window sill tracks
- [ ] Toilet brush deep soak
- [ ] Cabinet hinges wiped & cleaned
- [ ] Desk cable wrangle & wipe
- [ ] Plant leaves wiped & rotated
- [ ] Filters swapped (air / HVAC)

Small dailies — the quiet heroes

- [ ] Dishes out of sink before coffee
- [ ] Make the bed (any shape counts)
- [ ] One laundry load, all phases
- [ ] Wipe kitchen counters
- [ ] 5-min entryway reset
- [ ] Take out the trash
- [ ] Toilet bowl quick swish
- [ ] Spot-sweep the kitchen
- [ ] “Everything home” sweep — toys, remotes, cups

- [ ] Shoes to the shoe zone
- [ ] Mail sorted: recycle, action, shred
- [ ] Straighten pillows & throws
- [ ] Clear the dining table to bare
- [ ] Bathroom sink wipe
- [ ] Two-minute desk reset

How to combine (the honest math)

Dailies first, always. Thirty seconds of counters today saves ten minutes of dried splatter next week. Deep cleans follow the season; dailies keep the deep clean from being undone. Do the deep clean of a room, then bolt on its dailies while you're still in the room and while the tools are out. That stagger is how whole houses stay clean on ten minutes a day.

Daily-done log

M / T / W / T / F / S / S	HOW MANY DAILIES?
___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	
___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	
___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	
___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___	

Two lines to remember

Dailies are the moat; deep cleans are the castle. Skipping a daily doesn't ruin the season — missing a week of them is what makes deep cleans feel impossible. Missing one daily is a Tuesday, not a verdict.

If you live with other people

Hand this page out at dinner once, let each person keep the dailies they'd actually do, and post the chosen grid on the fridge. Chore negotiation once per season, not every Saturday.

Ninety percent of a clean home is the daily forty. It shows up for everyone; you just have to notice it enough to value it.